

Social Impact Assessment Report

Detailed analysis of the Menstrual Hygiene Education Sessions

Organized by:

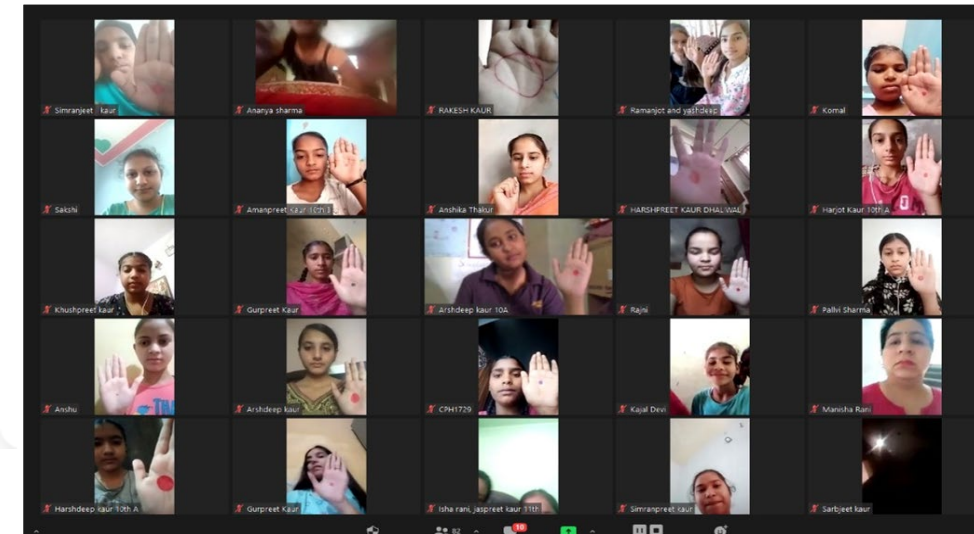
District Administration Rupnagar • District Program Office Rupnagar

District Development Fellowship • The Crimson Project



About the Initiative

- 🎯 **Project Crimson** aims to eliminate stereotypes associated with Menstruation by educating and empowering communities to speak up and making products affordable.
- ⚠️ **The Challenge:** A large section of society perceives menstruation as impure. Women feel ashamed to discuss it, leaving young girls and boys critically uninformed.
- 👥 **Our Action:** Organized a Menstrual Education Programme for students of classes 6th to 12th under the highly successful Beti Bachao Beti Padhao Scheme.
- 📅 **Timeline:** Sessions ran successfully from 28th May to 10th June 2021.



Session Objectives

- ✓ **Core Education:** Educate adolescents on essential topics related to menstrual health and hygiene processes.
- ✓ **Building Awareness:** Ensure they are aware of the choices available to them regarding their sexual and reproductive health.
- ✓ **Comfortable Environment:** Provide relatable questions and stories to establish an environment of ease, trust, and comfort.
- ✓ **Safe Access:** Ensure students have a safe space to talk, discuss and learn, with easy access to necessities such as pads.
- ✓ **Inclusion & Normalization:** Break the mental block of menstruation being a “girl problem” and normalize an open dialogue amongst boys.

36

Total Sessions Conducted

5500+

GIRLS SENSITIZED

1000+

**BOYS
SENSITIZED**

Flow of the Sessions

Session Structure

4 sessions per day (2 girls, 2 boys), 60 mins each. Separated into Ice breaking, informative PPT, and Q&A

Conclusion & Impact

Concluded by Ms. Deepshikha Sharma, IAS Additional DC. Successfully covered 200+ schools, impacting 3000+ students

Inauguration

The sessions proudly began with the inauguration by respected Ms. Sonali Giri, IAS Deputy Commissioner

Rollout & Growth

Commenced with classes 6 & 7 (50 students), and rapidly progressed to higher classes with 100 attendees per session

Description of the Sessions



Girls' Sessions

- Commenced with interactive ice-breaker games to establish comfort and interactivity.
- Covered the menstrual process, puberty, PMS, pad usage & disposal, period tracking, PCOS, nutrition, and exercise.
- Common myths and taboos were actively discussed and dismantled.
- High interaction in the Q&A from classes 10-12 regarding periods, pain, discomfort, and proper pad usage.



Boys' Sessions

- Kicked off with interactive ice-breaker rounds to introduce the topic gradually.
- The process of menstruation was explained via an engaging, story-based format to improve conceptual understanding.
- Effectively normalized the biological process and broke down prevalent myths and taboos.
- Educated boys on their responsibilities towards girls and women, promoting sensitivity.

Detailed Topics Covered

Information for Girls

- Menstrual hygiene management and basics of the menstrual cycle.
- Puberty, bodily changes, and Premenstrual Syndrome (PMS).
- Effective period tracking and necessary nutrition.
- Breaking societal myths and taboos related to menstruation.
- Analysis of various menstrual products available in the market.
- Choices regarding sexual and reproductive health.
- Awareness of various health disorders, including PCOS.

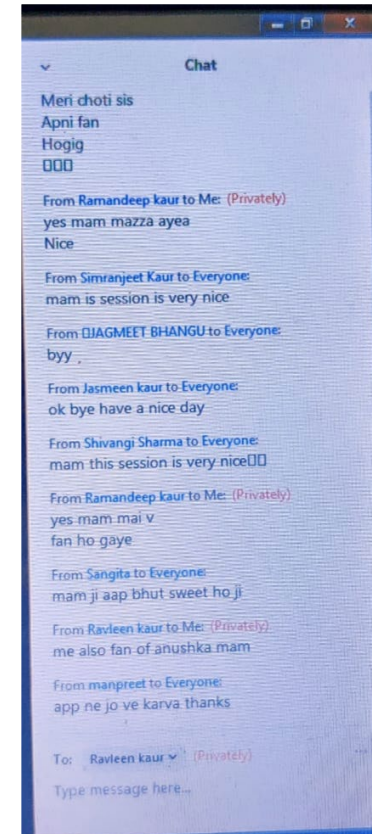
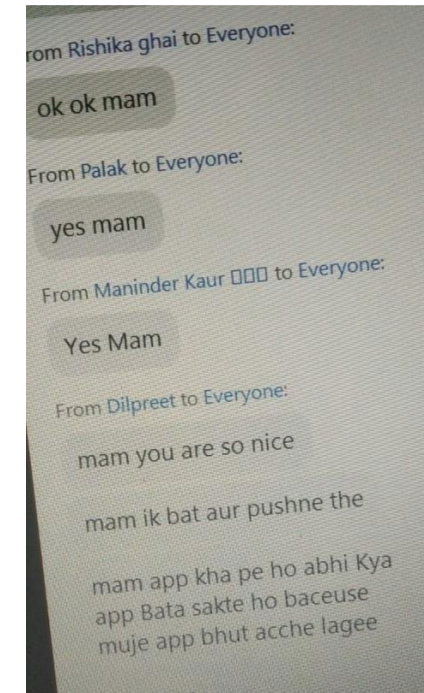
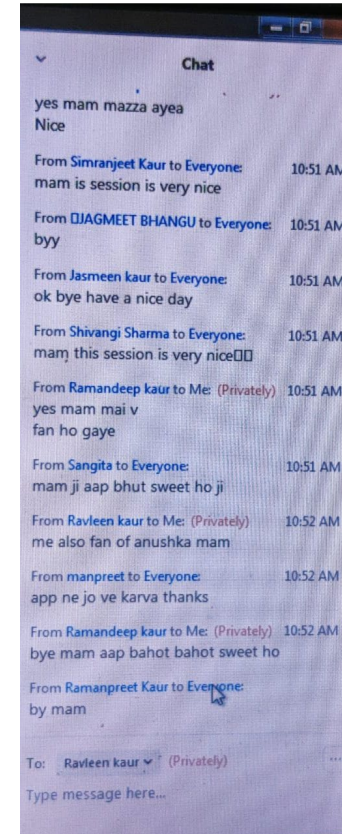
Information for Boys

- Understanding the biological process of menstruation.
- Debunking societal myths and presenting facts.
- Practical ways to help their mothers, sisters, and friends during these times.
- Sensitization towards the needs of others.
- Becoming a more responsible, empathetic, and supportive citizen.

The Q&A Round

Frequently Asked Questions during the sessions:

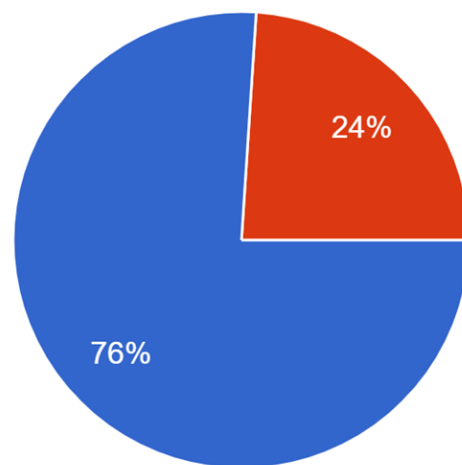
- Where do periods occur and why does it hurt during menstruation?
- Why doesn't a period happen to boys?
- Why use a sanitary pad and how frequently do periods occur?
- How to identify irregular periods and what steps are needed to regularise them?
- What exactly is PCOS?
- Clarifications on misconceptions (e.g., restrictions on entering places of worship, eating pickles/curd).
- What to eat and whether to exercise during periods to stay healthy.



Composition of Attendees

लिंग/Gender

217 responses

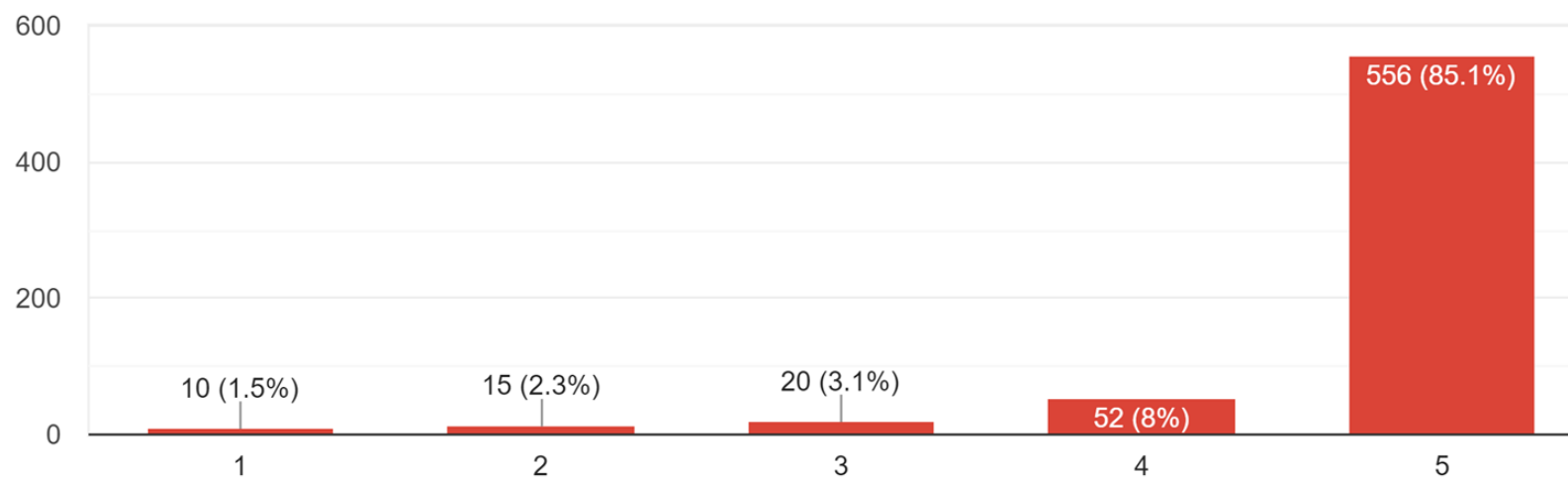


● महिला / Female
● पुरुष / Male

Feedback for the Session

हमारे द्वारा दी गई जानकारी कितनी उपयोगी थी?/How helpful was the information provided by us?

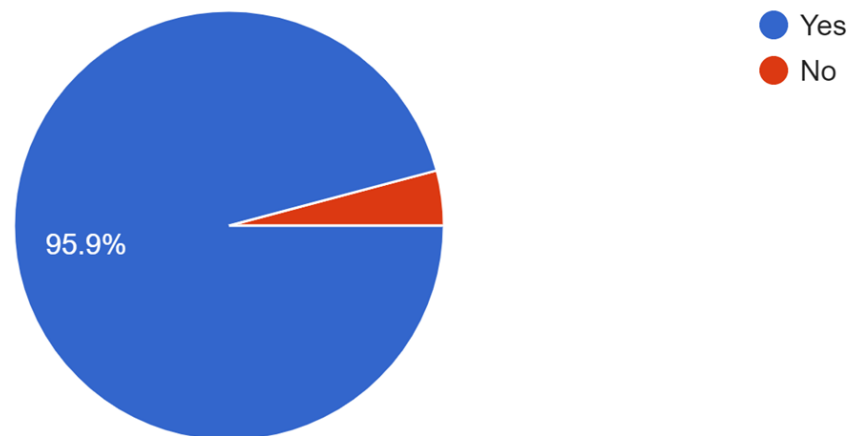
653 responses



Feedback for the Session

क्या आपको मासिक धर्म चक्र समझ आ गया?/Did you understand the menstrual cycle?

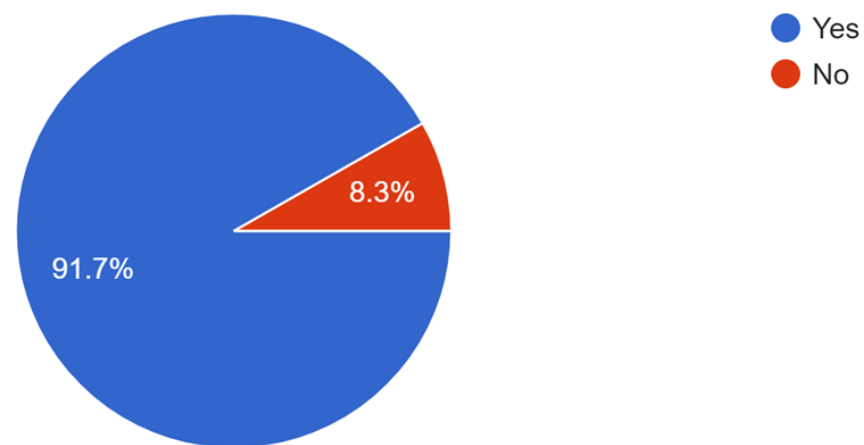
653 responses



Feedback for the Session

क्या अब आप पीरियड्स के दौरान हाइजीन का महत्व जानते हैं ?/Do you now understand the importance of hygiene during periods?

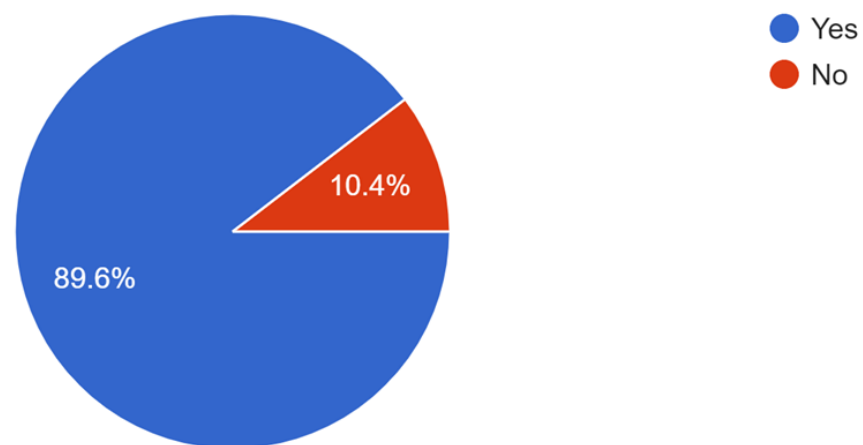
653 responses



Feedback for the Session

क्या आप PCOS और पीरियड्स में अनियमितता से होने वाले नुकसान के बारे में जान गए हैं?/Are you now aware of PCOS and the harms caused by irregular periods?

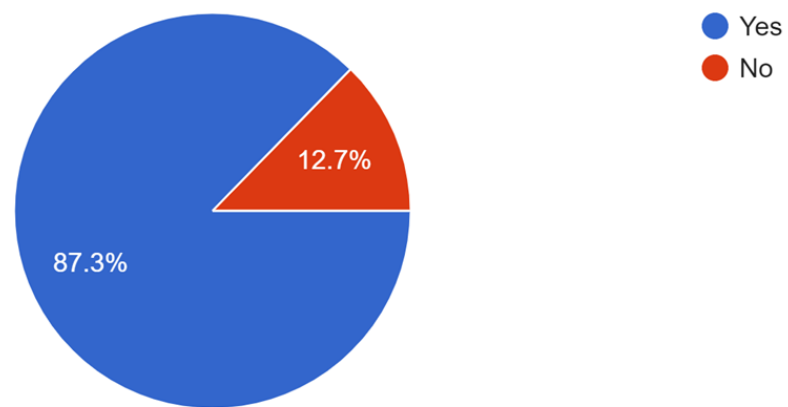
653 responses



Feedback for the Session

क्या अब आप समझ गए हैं कि मिथकों का कोई वैज्ञानिक आधार क्यों नहीं है?/Do you now understand why myths do not have any scientific grounds?

653 responses



Problems Faced & Adopted Solutions



Technical Issues

Students occasionally faced unstable connections or joining errors.

Alternative strategy: Educational recorded videos were prepared for those who couldn't attend the sessions properly.



Online Mode Constraints

Due to the online format, a deep personal level connection was difficult to form.

Solution: Speakers used relatable examples and highly visual PPTs to effectively bridge the communication gap.



Specific Medical Queries

Inquisitive students asked questions requiring deep medical expertise.

Solution: Speakers clearly advised students to discuss it with parents and further consult a doctor for detailed knowledge.

Recommendations for Future Execution



Gynecologist Involvement

As students were curious about specific medical details, the presence of a specialist like a gynecologist alongside speakers would make the sessions vastly more comprehensive.



Transition to Offline Sessions

Although the detailed and interactive online approach was successful, organizing offline sessions would foster an even better understanding and personal connection for students.



Expanded Boys' Reach

Since boys were slightly awkward/shy, we highly recommend more sessions specifically tailored for them to boost interaction.

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Conclusion

We would like to extend our immense gratitude to the District Administration, Rupnagar for their invaluable support throughout the programme. Project Crimson aims to extend this collaboration and organize follow-up offline sessions.

When it comes to menstruation, we encourage teachers to create an atmosphere of open dialogue and hope the administration facilitates this. This allows students to carry a positive mindset back home and put an end to discriminatory practices.
